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NEW ARTICLE

Profiles of inquiry-based instructional strategies in Austrian primary school science education

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WHAT DID THE RESEARCHERS INVESTIGATE?

- The study is the first empirical examination of inquiry-based instruction in Austrian primary science classrooms.
- It asks how far inquiry-based strategies are enacted, which instructional profiles teachers show, and how these relate to professionalisation and gender.
- Latent Class Analysis was applied to self-reports from 339 teachers in the 2019 TIMSS teacher survey.

Neubauer-Hametner et al. (2026) · Research in Science & Technological Education · doi.org/10.1080/02635143.2026.2657036

WHAT DID THEY FIND?

- The analysis revealed four distinct instructional profiles.
- About two-thirds of teachers reported combining inquiry-based strategies, yet only one profile reflected a comprehensive inquiry approach, with students engaged throughout the inquiry cycle.
- Profile membership was significantly associated with gender and professional development; the authors call for stronger reflective competencies in teacher education.

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